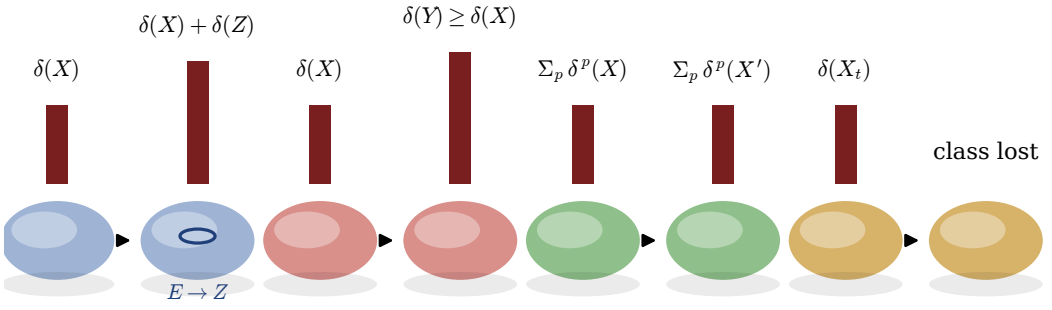The defect $\delta = \dim \mathrm{Hdg}/\mathrm{Alg}$ never drops: blow-up, domination, derived equivalence, degeneration